

Intro to Offensive Security

Introduction

This lab explored the introductory part of Offensive Security. Offensive security is the process of breaking into computer systems, exploiting software bugs, and finding loopholes in application to gain an authorized access to them. We saw that in also involves a range of proactive security strategies using some tactics malicious actors use in the real-world attacks to strengthen network security rather than harm it. On the flip side we covered defensive security, a process of protecting an organization's network and computer systems by analyzing and security any potential digital threat. In defensive cyber role investigation of infected computers or devices is involved to understand it was hacked, tracking down the cybercriminals or monitoring infrastructure for malicious activities. Technique and tool used in the lab include *GoBuster*

Objectives

- To understand what offensive security
- To hack a machine
- To understand the careers in cyber security

Methodology

Task 1

Covered Offensive Security, which the process of breaking into computer systems, exploiting software bugs, and finding loopholes in applications to gain unauthorized access to them. The task also touched on defensive security, which is the process of protecting an organization's network and computer systems by analyzing and securing any potential digital threats

Answer the questions below

Which of the following options better represents the process where you simulate a hacker's actions to find vulnerabilities in a system?

- Offensive Security
- Defensive Security

Offensive Security

✓ Correct Answer

Task 2

Used **GoBuster** to brute-force FakeBank's website to find hidden directories and pages. The tool takes a list of potential page or directory names and tries accessing a website with each of them.

Found potentially hidden pages on FakeBank's website using GoBuster tool.

```
ubuntu@tryhackme:~/Desktop$ gobuster -u http://fakebank.com -w wordlist.txt dir

=====
Gobuster v2.0.1                                OJ Reeves (@TheColonial)
=====
[+] Mode          : dir
[+] Url/Domain    : http://fakebank.com/
[+] Threads      : 10
[+] Wordlist      : wordlist.txt
[+] Status codes  : 200,204,301,302,307,403
[+] Timeout      : 10s
=====
2024/06/26 05:05:13 Starting gobuster
=====
/images (Status: 301)
/bank-transfer (Status: 200)
=====
2024/06/26 05:05:27 Finished
=====
ubuntu@tryhackme:~/Desktop$ d
```

Successfully hacked the bank.

Answer the questions below

If your transfer was successful, you should now be able to see your new balance reflected on your account page. Go there now and confirm you got the money! (You may need to hit Refresh for the changes to appear)

Above your account balance, you should now see a message indicating the answer to this question. Can you find the answer you need?

BANK-HACKED

✓ Correct Answer

🔍 Hint

If you were a penetration tester or security consultant, this is an exercise you'd perform for companies to test for vulnerabilities in their web applications; find hidden pages to investigate for vulnerabilities.

No answer needed

✓ Correct Answer

Terminate the machine by clicking the red "Terminate" button at the top of the page.

No answer needed

✓ Correct Answer

FakeBank | A

✓ Woop woop! Your answer is correct

Congratulations - you hacked the bank!
The answer to the TryHackMe question is **BANK-HACKED**

\$767.68
Account balance

Transactions

Hack FakeBank_v2.1 30min 37s

Task 2

Covered the careers in cyber security, essentially, a few offensive security roles, as in the shot below.

- Penetration Tester - Responsible for testing technology products for finding exploitable security vulnerabilities.
- Red Teamer - Plays the role of an adversary, attacking an organization and providing feedback from an enemy's perspective.
- Security Engineer - Design, monitor, and maintain security controls, networks, and systems to help prevent cyberattacks.

Conclusion

The module demonstrated how an attacker potentially attack and hack an organization as in the case provided of a bank. We were introduced to offensive security, which involve the process of breaking into a computer system and exploiting software bugs.

The lab also brought out the other side of offensive security which is defensive security. Defensive security, involves the process of protecting an organization's network and computer systems by analyzing and security any potential digital threat.

Task 1, differentiated offensive and defensive security. Task 2, covered a technique and tool used to brute-force urls in website and DNS subdomains among others. The final task of the lab covered some of the available careers in cybersecurity and path way to achieve once ideal cyber goals.